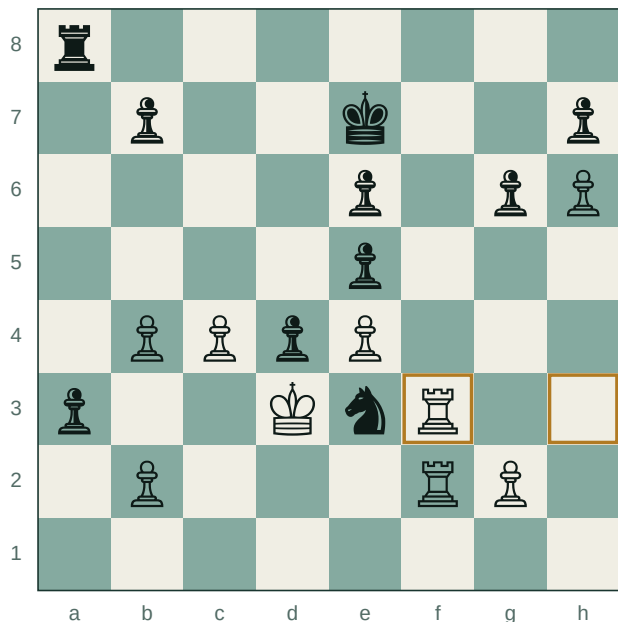


# Advanced-pawn tactics: Black, move 32

Advanced-pawn tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 32.Rhf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**32...a2 33. Rf7+ Kd6 34. c5+ Kc6 35. b5+ Kxc5**

**32...a2** The pawn moves from a3 to a2. Recorded reply: **33.Rf7+**.

**33...Kd6** The king moves from e7 to d6. Recorded reply: **34.c5+**.

**34...Kc6** The king moves from d6 to c6. Recorded reply: **35.b5+**.

**35...Kxc5** The king captures the pawn on c5.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

## HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on d3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.